

ONLY A COMMUNITY OF RESEARCHERS HAS A CHANCE OF REVEALING THE COMPLEX WHOLE

BIG ECOLOGY

IN CONTEXT

KEY ORGANIZATION

National Science Foundation (created 1950)

BEFORE

1926 Russian geochemist and mineralogist Vladimir Vernadsky formulates the theory of the biosphere in which everything on Earth lives.

1935 Pioneering British ecologist Arthur Tansley defines an ecosystem as encompassing all the interactions between a group of living creatures and their environment.

AFTER

1992 At the Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro, there is international consensus on the importance of protecting the biosphere.

1997 The Kyoto Protocol to reduce greenhouse gas emissions is signed by 192 countries.

An in-depth understanding of ecosystems requires long-term study. In 1980, the US National Science Foundation set up six Long Term Ecological Research (LTER) sites to study long-term, large-scale ecological phenomena. There are currently 28 sites, five of which have been running